Student Level 110

Reading Comprehension Intervention Passages

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Molly

Molly did not like vegetables. Her parents wanted her to eat vegetables. They said it was because they loved her. She learned at school that they would help her to be strong and healthy. But she was not ready to try.

Each night at dinner there was a vegetable on her plate. When she saw peas or corn on her plate she made a face. She did not try them. She just pushed them to the side. She did not think she would ever like to eat them.

One night her dad made broccoli. He put a small piece on Molly's plate. It was a pretty green color. She decided she was ready to try a bite. She put her fork in the broccoli. She put a tiny bit in her mouth. She chewed it. Her family watched her. Molly did not make a sour face. It tasted good. She liked it!

Molly was proud of herself for trying it. Her parents were proud of her, too. She was glad to know she liked broccoli. Now she would try vegetables every time.

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Questions for Molly

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Molly not like to eat?

2. Why did Molly's parents want her to eat vegetables?

3. How did Molly's parents try to get her to eat vegetables?

4. Why did Molly make a face when she saw the vegetables?

5. What were some of the vegetables that Molly's parents put on her plate that she didn't like?

6. What was the next vegetable that her parents tried?

7. Why do you think that Molly was ready to try the broccoli?

8. How do you think her family felt when they watched her try a tiny bit of the broccoli?

9. How did Molly feel about herself after she tried the broccoli?

10. Why do you think she felt proud?

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Nell

Nell was excited. Her dad was coming home today. He had been out of town for two weeks. She wanted to do something special for him. He would be home in an hour. They didn't have time to go to the store. She had to think of something else to do.

She went outside to think. She started to draw with chalk on their sidewalk. Then she got a great idea. She decided to make pictures on the sidewalk for her dad. She drew their family and happy faces. Soon she had covered the sidewalk with messages.

She heard a car pull up. It was her dad. She jumped up and gave him a big hug. He saw all the nice pictures and words. He said it was a perfect. Dad was surprised and happy.

Nell looked at her clothes and hands. She was covered in chalk. Now he was, too. They laughed. Nell was proud of the nice welcome she gave her dad.

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Questions for Nell

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Why was Nell excited?

2. Why did Nell want to do something special for him?

3. What did Nell do to the sidewalk?

4. Why did Nell think it was a great idea to draw on the sidewalk?

5. How did Nell know her dad was home?

6. Why did Nell give her dad a big hug?

7. How did Nell's dad like her drawings?

8. Why was he happy about the chalk drawings?

9. What did Nell see when she looked at her clothes and hands?

10. Why was her dad covered in chalk too?

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Ben

Ben and his family were going camping. The whole family loved to camp. This time, they were bringing their new dog, Scout. Scout had lots of energy. Ben's family thought he would like to go hiking with them.

Ben's family chose a campsite deep in the woods. They unloaded the car, then they set up their tent. After that, they ate a quick lunch. They were excited to go hiking. Scout had been sniffing around the campsite. They called him to join them.

Soon Ben's family were even deeper in the woods. The trees and bushes were very thick. The family stayed on the trail. Scout often left the trail and went to explore. They could hear him so they didn't worry. Then they heard loud barking. They wondered what Scout had found. They called for him to come back.

It didn't take long to know what Scout had found. It was a skunk! They could smell it before they even saw Scout. Scout was covered in skunk stink. He looked sad and embarrassed. Luckily, Ben and his family were camped near a river. Scout got a cold bath that afternoon. But at least he could sleep in the tent.

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Questions for Ben

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Ben and his family love to do?

2. Who were they taking on this camping trip?

3. Why did they think Scout would like to go hiking?

4. What did the family do after they unloaded the car and set up the tent?

5. Why did they eat quickly?

6. Why do you think Scout was sniffing around the campsite?

7. How could Ben and his family tell that Scout had found a skunk?

8. Why do you think Scout looked sad and embarrassed?

9. Why was it lucky that Ben's family were camped near a river?

10. How do you think Scout felt after his cold bath?

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Carlos

Carlos was excited about the weekend. He was going to visit his grandpa. His grandpa lived on a lake. He had a boat. Carlos loved to fish with his grandpa. His grandpa knew everything about fishing.

Carlos and his grandpa went fishing first thing. They made sandwiches to take on the boat. They wanted to stay on the lake all day. They also took water and snacks. Carlos couldn't wait to catch his first fish. He hoped it was a big one.

Carlos put the fattest worm on his hook. He dropped it over the side of the boat. Then he waited. And waited. Carlos and his grandpa talked quietly. They talked about school and homework. They talked about grandpa's job. They talked about family. And they waited some more.

Then Carlos felt a tug on his pole. His grandpa told him how to reel in the fish. When Carlos finally saw it, the fish was small. At first Carlos was sad. Then he thought about all the fish in the lake. He had plenty of time to catch a bigger one. Besides, he was happy just being with his grandpa.

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Questions for Carlos

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What was Carlos excited about?

2. Do you think that Carlos' grandpa really knew “everything” about fishing?

3. What did Carlos and his grandpa take on the boat with them?

4. Why did Carlos want to catch a big fish?

5. What did Carlos put on his hook?

6. Why didn't Carlos get impatient while fishing?

7. How did Carlos know he'd caught a fish?

8. Why was Carlos sad when he saw the fish?

9. What made Carlos feel better?

10. What else made Carlos feel better?

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Coral

Coral and her family were going to the park. They were going to play games and have a picnic. Every person helped get ready. They each had a job. Coral's job was to get the games ready. Everyone wanted to play something different. It was going to be a big job.

Rob wanted to play soccer. Coral found the soccer ball. She found cones to mark goals. Joey wanted to play catch. Coral found baseballs and gloves. Sally wanted to do hula hoop and jump rope. Coral found those things too. Now she had a huge pile of gear. And she was worn out.

Coral's dad came to ask if she was ready. She burst into tears. She said she worked too hard. She was too tired to go on the picnic. Her dad gave her a hug and asked what she wanted to do at the park. Coral sniffed. She said she just wanted to play with her family.

At the park, Coral's family set up for their picnic. Then it was time for games. Coral's dad told them how hard Coral had worked. They all agreed that Coral should choose what to play first. Now Coral was full of energy.

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Questions for Coral

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Where was Coral's family going?

2. Why did everyone in the family help get ready?

3. What was Coral's job?

4. Why was it going to be a big job?

5. What kinds of balls did Coral find?

6. Why did Coral burst into tears with her dad?

7. What did her dad do to comfort her?

8. What did Coral mean when she said that she "just wanted to play with her family"?

9. What did Coral's family do first when they got to the park?

10. Why did Coral have so much energy at the end of the story?

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Emma

Emma was happy. Her friend Lucy was coming over today. Emma wanted to show Lucy her new game. It was a game they could play together. It was called Guess What. Emma was tired of playing with her family. She was excited to play with someone new.

Lucy got to Emma's house before lunch. They ate cheese sandwiches with fruit and milk for lunch. Then Emma got out Guess What. She told Lucy how to play. Lucy said that she didn't understand all the rules. Emma said that she would learn quickly. She said she would help Lucy.

The two girls started to play. Right away, Lucy made a mistake. She felt bad about it. Emma told her to try again. The next time it was Lucy's turn, she did okay. She felt better. But the next time, she made another mistake. Lucy said she didn't want to play anymore.

Emma said that she made mistakes at first, too. She said her family helped her get better. She wanted to do the same for Lucy. The girls took their time playing the game. When Lucy went home, she was almost as good as Emma. They couldn't wait to play again.

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Questions for Emma

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What is the name of Emma's friend?

2. What was Emma's new game called?

3. Why was Emma tired of playing with her family?

4. Why was Emma excited to play with Lucy?

5. What did Emma and Lucy have for lunch?

6. Do you think Emma could have explained the rules better?

7. How did Lucy do when they began to play?

8. How did that make Lucy feel?

9. What did Emma do to make Lucy feel better?

10. By the time she left Emma's house, Lucy was almost as good at playing Guess What as Emma. Was she excited to play it again?

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John

John was very good at drawing. He loved to draw things in nature. He was tired of using crayons. He wanted to try using paints, too. But he didn't have any.

His older brother Pete had watercolor paints. One day, John watched his brother paint. Pete said John could share his paints. He got out more paper and brushes. Now John was ready to paint.

He wanted to paint a bright orange sunset. John looked at the paint but there was no orange. Pete said they could mix colors. He said mixing yellow and red would make orange. John dipped his brush in the yellow and then added some red. When he mixed them together, they made orange.

John finished the sunset. It was just right. He was happy that he learned how to paint. It was going to be fun to mix colors. He was lucky Pete was such a nice big brother.

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Questions for John

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Who is this story about?

2. Why does John want to learn to paint?

3. What is John's older brother named?

4. Why do you think that John likes to watch Pete paint?

5. How did Pete help John get ready to paint??

6. How do you think John felt about Pete sharing his paints?

7. What did John want to paint first?

8. John was probably surprised that there wasn't an orange paint. Why would that be surprising?

9. What two colors did John mix together to make orange?

10. Do you think John will continue to paint?

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Jordan

Jordan loved bears. All kinds of bears. He liked brown bears. He liked black bears. He even liked grizzly bears. But his favorites were polar bears. He had stuffed bears and books about bears. Jordan's dream was to see a real bear.

On Jordan's birthday, his mom had a surprise for him. She said they were going on a road trip. They drove three hours to get to their hotel. Jordan was excited. The hotel had a pool! He wanted to swim right away. He thanked his mom for his birthday gift. His mom said there was more to the surprise.

They got back in the car. Jordan didn't know what to expect. Pretty soon they passed a sign that said ZOO. His mom said this zoo had a new area just for bears. Jordan couldn't believe it. He wanted to scream with joy. He hugged his mom instead.

Jordan saw two polar bears and their cub. He saw how they lived. He watched their feeding time. He watched them play together. Jordan knew he would never forget that day. After the zoo, he swam at the hotel until he was worn out. It was the best birthday ever!

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Questions for Jordan

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What kind of animal did Jordan love?

2. Before his birthday, had Jordan ever seen a real bear?

3. Where did Jordan and his mom go first on his birthday?

4. Why did Jordan thank his mom when they got to the hotel?

5. Where did Jordan and his mom go next?

6. Why didn't Jordan go ahead and scream with joy?

7. What kind of bears did Jordan see at the zoo?

8. How do you think Jordan felt when he watched the bears?

9. What did Jordan do after the zoo?

10. Why did Jordan think this was the "best birthday ever"?

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Lila

Lila woke up with a cold. Her nose was stuffed up. She had a headache. Her throat was sore. She did not feel well at all. Lila's mom said she should stay home from school. Lila agreed.

Lila went back to bed. She piled up all her stuffed animals around her. She pulled her covers up to her chin. Then she just lay there. She was feeling really sorry for herself. She tried to tell her stuffed animals how bad she felt. But her throat was too sore. They didn't talk, but she could tell they felt bad for her. She just lay there some more.

Soon Lila's mom came in to check on Lila. Lila could only whisper. She said she never felt worse in her whole life. Lila's mom felt her forehead and said she'd be right back. She came back with ice chips for Lila to suck on. Lila said they helped. But only a little bit.

Later that day, Lila was feeling a little better. She sat on the sofa and watched TV. For dinner she ate some soup. Lila stayed home one more day. Then her mom said it was time to go back to school.

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Questions for Lila

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Lila wake up with?

2. Why did Lila agree with her mom that she should stay home from school?

3. What did Lila do when she went back to bed?

4. What did it mean that Lila was “feeling really sorry for herself”?

5. What happened when she tried to talk to her stuffed animals?

6. Do you think that Lila's stuffed animals really felt bad for her?

7. What did Lila's mom do when she came to check on her?

8. Why did she do that?

9. Lila started to feel better. What did she eat for dinner?

10. Why did Lila's mom say it was time to go back to school after one more day at home?

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Coco

Coco woke up early. She was thirsty and a little crabby. Coco really wanted a glass of orange juice. She went into the kitchen and opened the refrigerator. But there was no orange juice. Coco got even crabbier.

She asked her mom where the juice was. Her mom said they drank it all. She said they would get some later at the store. But Coco wanted some right then!

Her mom smiled nicely at Coco. She said they could make their own orange juice. Luckily, they had fresh oranges in their fruit bowl. They washed two oranges and cut them in half. Then they used a squeezer and got the juice out of each half. Her mom did the first one. Coco did the others. They poured the juice into glasses.

They drank the juice. Coco smiled and said it was the best juice she ever had. Now she knew how to make orange juice. She wanted to do it again tomorrow morning. Her mom hoped she got better sleep tonight!

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Questions for Coco

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. How did Coco feel when she woke up?

2. Why did Coco get even crabbier when she found there wasn't any orange juice?

3. What did her mom say happened to all the juice?

4. Why did Coco's mom smile at her even though she was being crabby and kind of rude?

5. What did her mom say they could do?

6. Why was it lucky that they had oranges in their fruit bowl?

7. What were the first two things they did with the oranges?

8. Why do you think Coco's mom used the squeezer first?

9. What did Coco say about the juice they made?

10. Why did Coco's mom hope that Coco got better sleep that night?

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Dennis

Dennis loved to swing. His little sister Ann liked to swing, too. But she needed someone to push her. When she wanted to swing Dennis had to get off his swing and push her. He wished he didn't have to push her.

He had an idea. He could teach her to swing herself. He asked her if she wanted to learn how to push herself. She said yes. Dennis said he would teach her. He had to think about each step.

First, Ann watched him swing. He sat in the swing with his feet on the ground. He stepped back a few steps. Then he put his feet up and the swing went forward. He put his legs out as he went forward. Then he bent his legs as he went back. Ann watched. Now it was her turn to try. Dennis helped her do each step.

Soon she was swinging on her own. Dennis got on the swing next to her. Now they could swing at the same time. They were both very happy.

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Questions for Dennis

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Dennis love to do?

2. Why did Dennis wish that he didn't have to push Ann in her swing?

3. Why did Dennis wish that he didn't have to push Ann in her swing?
What was Dennis' idea?

4. Why did he have to think about each step?

5. Before he started explaining what to do, what did Ann do?

6. How would watching Dennis help Ann learn?

7. When Dennis showed Ann how to swing, what parts of his body did he use?

8. When it was Ann's turn to try, how do you think Dennis helped her?

9. Did it take long for Ann to learn?

10. Why were both Dennis and Ann happy?

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Jen

Jen and her mom planted a garden every year. They always planted carrots, peas and beans. This year Jen wanted to plant something new.

Jen and her mom went to the garden store. They looked at the seeds. Jen looked at corn seeds. But corn needs a bigger garden. She looked at lettuce seeds. Her mom said the rabbits would eat it. Then she saw the sunflower seeds. They were big and yellow. They need a sunny spot. The plants grow very tall. Jen and her mom decided they were a great choice.

Jen planted the seeds when they got home. She planted all the sunflower seeds at the back of the garden because they would grow very tall. Each day Jen watered the seeds. She watched the seedlings grow. And grow and grow.

By the end of the summer they were taller than the garage! The flower faces were huge and they turned to face the sun. Jen's mom took a picture of Jen next to the sunflowers. They were so happy they'd tried something new.

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Questions for Jen

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Jen and her mom do every year?

2. Why do you think Jen wanted to plant something new?

3. What two vegetables did Jen consider?

4. Why weren't corn and lettuce going to work?

5. What seeds did Jen look at next?

6. Why did Jen and her mom decide to get the sunflower seeds?

7. What did Jen do when they got home?

8. Why did Jen water the seeds every day?

9. How big were the sunflowers by the end of the summer?

10. Based on the story, do you think Jen and her mom will plant sunflowers again?

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Jimmy

Jimmy wished he could jump rope. He saw kids at the park jumping rope. He watched kids in his neighborhood jump rope. They asked him to try but he was worried he would trip on the rope.

One day, his friend Rosie came over to play. She brought two jump ropes. Jimmy told Rosie that he did not know how to jump rope. She said she would show him. They went outside. First he watched her jump rope. Rosie went through each step slowly.

Then Jimmy tried it with the other jump rope. He tried to do all the steps. Jimmy did everything that Rosie did. After many times, he did it. He was so excited. He tried again. He was getting the hang of it.

Rosie had to go home for lunch. She said Jimmy could keep the jump rope to practice. He practiced all afternoon. He practiced the next morning. When Rosie came over to play he said he had a big surprise. Now he could jump rope, too. He was so happy. Rosie was happy, too.

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Questions for Jimmy

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Jimmy wish he could do?

2. Why was he worried about tripping on the rope?

3. Who was Jimmy's friend?

4. Why did Rosie offer to show Jimmy how to jump rope?

5. What did they do first?

6. How did Rosie try to make it easy for Jimmy to learn?

7. What did Jimmy do next?

8. Why was Jimmy getting excited?

9. Why did Rosie have to leave?

10. Why do you think Rosie was happy with Jimmy's surprise the next day?

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Mary

Mary really wanted to lose a tooth. She asked her mom and dad when it would happen. All of her friends at school had lost a tooth. She checked her teeth every night after she brushed them. But they were not loose.

One day Mary was having pizza for dinner. She took a big bite. Her front tooth moved a little. She touched it with her finger. It was a tiny bit loose. Mary finally had a loose tooth. She couldn't wait for school the next day.

For the next week she wiggled her tooth with her finger. She moved her tooth with her tongue. Every day it moved more and more. Soon it was loose enough to twist a little bit. Mary's friends said that was a good sign.

Then one day at school the tooth fell out. She showed her friends. Her teacher wrapped the tooth in a tissue. Mary put it in her pocket to bring home. Mary was excited to show her mom and dad. She knew they'd be surprised.

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Questions for Mary

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Mary want to happen?

2. Why did she want to lose a tooth?

3. What was Mary eating when she felt one of her teeth get loose?

4. Why was Mary excited for school the next day?

5. What did Mary do to make her tooth looser?

6. Why did her friends tell her it was a good sign that she could twist her toot a little bit?

7. Where was Mary when her tooth fell out?

8. Why do you think she showed her friends?

9. What did Mary's teacher do with the tooth?

10. Why did Mary think her parents would be surprised when they saw her tooth?

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Mike

Mike's teacher talked to his class about chores. She said it was good to help out at home. She told her students to think of jobs they could help with at home.

Mike wanted to help at home. He asked his parents what he could do. He asked if he could babysit his baby sister. His mom said he was too young. He asked if he could paint the garage. His dad thought he was too small. Mike needed to think of other jobs.

Mike went outside. He jumped in the leaves. He raked the leaves back into a pile. Then Mike had an idea. He asked his dad for leaf bags. Then he put the leaves in the bags. He had leaves stuck to his clothes and hair. He ran inside to tell his mom and dad.

His parents were very happy. Mike was proud of his work. Then his mom asked him to help with another job. She asked him to pick the leaves up from the floor. They all laughed. Mike cleaned up the leaves in the house. He was excited to tell his teacher about the job that he did at home.

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Questions for Mike

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Mike's teacher talk to the class about?

2. Why did she tell the students to think of chores they could do at home?

3. What did Mike ask his mom if he could do?

4. Why would Mike's mom think he was too young?

5. What did Mike ask his dad if he could do?

6. Why did Mike's dad think he was too small?

7. What did Mike do next?

8. How did jumping in the leaves help Mike think of another chore he could do?

9. What was the last chore Mike's mom asked him to help with?

10. How did the leaves get on the floor?

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Sally

Sally liked to run and jump. She wanted to learn how to skip too. Sally wanted to skip like her friends. She tried and tried but couldn't do it. She asked her friends for help. They wanted to help, but didn't know how to teach Sally.

Sally thought her mom could teach her. She couldn't find her mom anywhere in the house. Her Mom was outside. She was mowing the lawn. The mower was very loud. Sally's mom just smiled at Sally.

Then Sally looked for her dad. He was in the kitchen, busy making dinner. He didn't have time to teach her. He said Sally should ask her brother, Tom.

Tom was in his room and Sally knocked on the door. He was done with his homework. He said he could teach Sally how to skip. They went outside. She watched him skip. Tom skipped very slowly. He showed her each step. Sally tried it. She followed Tom up and down the sidewalk. Now she could skip, too!

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Questions for Sally

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Sally want to learn to do?

2. Why did Sally want to skip like her friends?

3. Who did Sally ask to teach her first?

4. Why couldn't they teach her?

5. Who did Sally think could teach her next?

6. Why didn't Sally's mom help her?

7. What was Sally's dad doing when she asked him for help?

8. Why couldn't he help her?

9. Who does her dad tell her to ask for help?

10. What kind of a brother is Tom?

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Sam

Sam loved birds. He thought they were funny and he liked their feathers. His family had a bird feeder in their yard. From the kitchen window, he could see them come for food.

One day he saw some birds doing something very strange. They were on the ground in a patch of dirt. They flapped their wings and rolled around. They got very dirty. Sam did not know what they were doing. He was worried that they were hurt. He wanted to find out what they were doing.

He knew who he could ask. He called his Grandma. She knew a lot about nature and animals. He asked if she knew what the birds were doing in the dirt. She said they were taking a bath. He thought that was funny. They were getting dirty, not clean. She said the dirt helps take oil off their feathers. Sam thanked his Grandma and said he felt better.

Now Sam knows what the birds are doing. He is happy that his Grandma knows so much about birds. He couldn't wait to tell his class about the dirt bird-bath!

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Questions for Sam

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Sam love to watch?

2. Why would Sam think that birds were funny?

3. What did Sam see the birds doing one day that worried him?

4. Why did Sam worry that they might have been hurt?

5. Who did Sam call to ask for advice?

6. Why did he think that she would be able to tell him what was going on?

7. What did Sam's grandma say when he asked her what the birds were doing in the dirt?

8. Why did Sam think that was funny?

9. Why were the birds taking a bath in the dirt?

10. Why did Sam want to share the story with his class?

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Tommy

Tommy was excited. His dad was taking him camping for the first time. He couldn't wait to sleep in a tent. After they set up the tent, they put their sleeping bags inside. When it got dark, they got ready for bed. They used flashlights to see in their tent.

Dad said it was time to go to sleep. They turned their flashlights off. Tommy listened to the night sounds. He heard hoots. Tommy was worried about what was making the sounds. He turned his flashlight back on. He told his dad he was scared.

His dad said it was nothing to worry about. He said it was an owl family. The owls were just waking up. Tommy thought that was funny. He was going to sleep at the same time the owls were getting up. His dad explained that the owls are nocturnal. That meant they sleep in the day and hunt and eat at night.

Tommy's dad said some hoots might be the parents saying it was time to get up. Other hoots might be the babies saying they were hungry. Tommy wasn't afraid of the sounds anymore. As he fell asleep, he wondered what they were saying.

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Questions for Tommy

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What was Tommy excited about?

2. Why did they know it was time to get ready for bed when it got dark?

3. How could they see inside the tent?

4. Why do you think Tommy was scared of the noises he heard?

5. What did his dad say was making the noises?

6. Why did Tommy's dad tell him not to worry about the owls?

7. What did Tommy think it was funny about the owls?

8. Did the author mean funny in a jokey way?

9. What does “nocturnal” mean?

10. Why wasn't Tommy afraid as he went to sleep?

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Tony

Tony wanted to learn how to ice skate. He needed skates. His brother had grown out of his old skates. He said Tony could have them. Tony tried them on and they fit. Now Tony could learn to skate, too. He was very happy.

On Saturday afternoon, Tony and his family went to the ice rink at the park. They went into the warming house to put their skates on. Tony's dad helped Tony. They were ready to skate.

When Tony stepped onto the ice, he slipped and fell. He was embarrassed and sore. It was hard to get back up with skates on. His dad helped him up, but Tony fell again. He wanted to give up.

Then his dad brought over a special chair for Tony. He said it would help Tony keep his balance. Tony remembered when his brother used a chair, too. Tony stood up on his skates and held onto the chair. He started to skate and push the chair. It did help. He skated around the rink pushing the chair. He was happy to be skating. Next time he would try it without the chair.

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Questions for Tony

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Tony want to learn to do?

2. Do you think Tony's brother was older or younger?

3. Where did Tony and his family go to put on their skates? ?

4. Why did they go there?

5. What happened when Tony stepped onto the ice?

6. Why did he feel embarrassed and sore?

7. What happened next?

8. Why did Tony feel like giving up?

9. What helped Tony feel better about skating?

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Will

Will went to his friend Joe's house to play. Joe had a new kitten. Will didn't have any pets. He was excited and a little nervous to meet the kitten.

Joe asked Will if he wanted to hold the kitten. Will was not sure. The kitten came over to sniff Will's feet. It was gray and white and its ears were very big. It sniffed Will's fingers. The kitten's nose was pink and wet. The whiskers tickled his hand. Will moved a little and the kitten jumped. Then it batted at Will's legs. Joe said it wanted to play. He got a string and pulled it across the floor. The kitten chased it back and forth. The boys laughed.

After a while the kitten stopped running around. It sat still and yawned. Joe said the kitten was tired. Now Will wanted to hold it. Joe picked up the kitten and put it in Will's lap. He petted the kitten. The fur was so soft.

Then Will heard a strange noise. He asked Joe if the kitten was growling. Joe laughed. He said the kitten was purring. It was happy to be in Will's lap. That made Will feel better.

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Questions for Will

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Will's friend Joe have at his house?

2. Why was Will a little nervous about meeting the kitten?

3. What was the first thing the kitten did to Will?

4. Why do you think the kitten did that?

5. What did the kitten look like?

6. How could Joe tell that the kitten wanted to play?

7. How did the boys play with the kitten? .

8. How could Joe tell the kitten was tired?

9. Why did Will want to hold the kitten when it was tired?

10. Why was Will happy that the kitten was purring?

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Lori

Lori had a new puppy. Her family named him Baby. Baby slept a lot. When he wasn't sleeping he had lots of energy. Sometimes Baby got into trouble. When Baby got into trouble, Lori tried to fix it.

Baby chewed on everything. Sometimes he peed on the rugs. It was hard work trying to cover up his mistakes. Lori didn't know if she could do it much longer.

One day, Lori saw Baby sleeping on the kitchen floor. Then she noticed a bad smell. She saw chewed up paper and icky food on the floor. Baby had gotten into the garbage. Lori tried to clean up the food and paper. She waved her arms around to get rid of the stink. Baby thought she was playing. He jumped and barked.

Lori's mom came in when she heard Baby barking. She saw that he had gotten into the garbage. She thanked Lori for cleaning up. Then she said that Baby had to learn better manners. She said that Baby was going to puppy school. There he would learn not to get into trouble. Lori was so happy, she hugged her mom and Baby.

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Questions for Lori

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What is the girl's name in this story?

2. What is the puppy's name in this story?

3. Why did Baby sleep a lot?

4. Why did Lori try to fix things when Baby got into trouble?

5. What kind of trouble did Baby get into?

6. Why was Lori afraid that she wouldn't be able to hide Baby's mistakes much longer?

7. How did Lori know that Baby had gotten into the garbage?

8. Why did Baby think Lori was playing with him?

9. Where did Lori's mom say that Baby was going?

10. Why was Lori happy at that news?

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Min

Min woke up one December morning and looked outside. She saw snowflakes in the air. They were big and fluffy. She was so excited. Min wanted to race outside to play in the snow.

She quickly got dressed and ran to the back door. Her mom said she needed to eat breakfast first. Min went to the kitchen. She sat down and had toast and juice. Now she was ready.

She ran to the back door again. Her mom said she needed to put on her winter clothes. Min got her jacket and snow pants from the closet. She found her boots. She looked for her mittens but only found one. Then she looked under the table and found the other one. She grabbed her hat. Min put everything on. Now she really was ready.

Min ran out the door and into the snow. She rolled in the snow. She made a snow angel. Then she looked up at the snowflakes coming down. They were cold on her cheeks. They were cold on her tongue. Inside, Min was warm and happy.

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Questions for Min

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Min see when she looked outside?

2. Do you think Min likes snow?

3. What did Min's mom make her do first before she could go outside?

4. Do you think Min ate breakfast quickly or slowly?

5. After she finished breakfast, Min's mom made her do something else before she could go outside. What was that?

6. How do you think Min's other mitten got under the table?

7. What did Min do in the snow?

8. Do you think Min lives in a place where there might be alligators?

9. Why did Min feel warm and happy inside even though it was snowing?

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Robert

Robert was going for a horse ride. He was very nervous. He had never ridden a horse before. Robert's friend James had a horse. James asked Robert to come for a ride. James said Robert could ride a very gentle horse. The horse was named Buddy.

James lived on a farm and Robert went one Saturday to ride Buddy. When he got there, he saw that Buddy was huge. How he was even going to get on Buddy? How would he stay on Buddy? James told Robert that he would help.

James' dad came with a small stepladder. Robert climbed up and sat on Buddy. Buddy didn't even look at Robert. When Robert looked down, he got dizzy. James' dad told Robert to look straight ahead. Then James' dad started walking. He held a rope that was tied to Buddy. Buddy started walking too. Robert was so scared, he almost started to cry.

James' dad led Buddy and Robert around in a circle. They went very slowly. Soon, Robert was feeling better about being on Buddy. James' horse was even bigger than Buddy. Robert hoped that he could ride like James one day.

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Questions for Robert

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What was Robert nervous about?

2. Why did James tell Robert he could ride Buddy?

3. Where did James live?

4. Why was Robert worried when he saw how big Buddy was?

5. What did James' dad use to help Robert get on Buddy?

6. Why didn't Buddy even look at Robert?

7. What happened when Robert looked down from on top of Buddy?

8. Why did James' dad tell Robert to look straight ahead?

9. How did James' dad keep control of Buddy?

10. Do you think Robert will go back for more rides?

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Sophie

Sophie wanted her school day to end. She was excited to get home. The day before, her family had adopted a kitten. Sophie chose the name Buttons for the kitten. She couldn't wait to get home to see Buttons.

Sophie ran all the way home after school. When she got there, she was tired and hungry. Her mom told her to sit down and have a snack. Sophie was sad that Buttons wasn't there to greet her. She quickly finished her snack. Then she went to look for Buttons.

Sophie looked all over the first floor. She called out for Buttons. Buttons didn't come. She looked under the sofa and chairs. She looked behind the desk. She opened all the closets. Buttons wasn't anywhere. Sophie was getting worried.

Sophie went upstairs to look for Buttons. She looked almost everywhere. She still couldn't find the kitten. The last place she looked was her own bedroom. There was Buttons! The kitten was curled up in a patch of sunshine on Sophie's bed. Sophie lay down next to Buttons who purred loudly. Sophie felt the same as Buttons.

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Questions for Sophie

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. Who is this story about?

2. Why was Sophie excited to see Buttons?

3. What did Sophie's mom tell her to do when she first got home?

4. Why was Sophie sad that Buttons wasn't there to greet her?

5. What are some of the places Sophie looked for Buttons on the first floor?

6. Why would Sophie feel worried when she couldn't find Buttons?

7. Where did Sophie go next to look for Buttons?

8. How do you think Sophie felt when she couldn't find Buttons right away upstairs either?

9. Where did Sophie finally find Buttons?

10. How do you think both Buttons and Sophie were feeling at the end of the story?

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Zoe

Zoe got a fish for her birthday. She named it Fred. Fred was a goldfish. Zoe was surprised he was called a goldfish. She thought he was orange. Fred lived in a glass bowl. There were small blue rocks at the bottom. There was also a green plant in his bowl. Zoe loved to watch Fred swim. But she worried that Fred was lonely.

Zoe took care of Fred. She fed him every day. She cleaned his bowl every week. She wanted him to be happy. She asked for another fish. Her mom said okay if Zoe cared for both fish. Zoe said she didn't mind. She wanted Fred to be happy.

The next day, Zoe got another fish. She named this one Betty. Fred and Betty didn't seem to like each other. They swam away from each other. Zoe thought that Fred was even more unhappy. She was sad when she went to bed that night.

The next morning, Zoe went to see the fish. Fred and Betty were swimming together! Zoe was so happy. It was even more fun to watch them swim together. She could tell Fred was happy, too.

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Questions for Zoe

Think about the story you just read and briefly answer these questions.

1. What did Zoe get for her birthday?

2. Why was Zoe surprised that Fred was a goldfish?

3. What color were the rocks at the bottom of Fred's bowl?

4. Why would Zoe be worried that Fred was lonely?

5. Who took care of Fred?

6. Why did she ask for another fish?

7. What did Zoe name the second fish?

8. Why was Zoe sad after they got Betty?

9. What did Zoe see the next morning?

10. How would Zoe be able to tell that Fred felt better being with Betty?

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